BY ORDER OF THE SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

AIR FORCE MISSION DIRECTIVE 3

21 OCTOBER 2026

AIR EDUCATION AND TRAINING COMMAND

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This mission directive implements Department of the Air Force Policy Directive 38-1, *Manpower and Organization* and Air Force Instruction 38-107, *Air Force Mission Directives*. This directive states the mission, command, and responsibilities for Air Education and Training Command (AETC).This publication may not be supplemented. However, it may be used as a reference when creating mission directives, instructions, and manuals for subordinate units. Refer recommended changes and questions related to this publication to the Office of Primary Responsibility using the Department of the Air Force (DAF) Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*; route DAF Forms 847 from field units through the appropriate chain of command. Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program,* and are disposed in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This document has been substantially revised and must be reviewed in its entirety. To the extent this directive is inconsistent with other publications dated prior to this directive, the guidance and information herein prevails, and this guidance will be integrated into those publications during subsequent publication efforts in accordance Department of the Air Force Instruction (DAFI) 90-160, *Publications and Forms Management and DAF Manual* (DAFMAN) 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures.*

1. Mission. AETC is responsible for force development over the span of the military Airman's career and is the lead command for United States Air Force (USAF) uniformed personnel force development activities, opportunities, and services. As such AETC provides citizen development, recruits, trains, and educates USAF personnel, and provides operational and tactical support to DAF civilian, United States Space Force (USSF), and non-DAF personnel force development efforts.

2. Command.

2.1. The Commander, AETC (COMAETC) is:

2.1.1. Responsible to the Secretary of the Air Force (SecAF) and the Chief of Staff of the Air Force (CSAF) to execute and optimize force development in accordance with **paragraph 2.1.1.1** (this does not include transactional functions other than listed in AFMD-3) with advice from Functional Authorities and in collaboration with Major Commands. This will be executed in a manner that does not abrogate statutory, higher headquarters, and SecAF- and CSAF-assigned authorities, guidance, and responsibi1ities that commanders, directors, and Functional Authorities otherwise are required to independently execute within their respective roles and responsibilities.

2.1.1.1. Executing force development includes, but is not limited to citizen development, marketing, recruiting and accessions, institutional training, education, and leader development.

2.1.2. The enterprise-wide voice and integrator for USAF force development activities, operations, and services, and resolves tensions to achieve balance between DAF training requirements, force development resourcing constraints and restraints, and AETC training timelines to deliver quality Airmen to meet operational needs. As such, COMAETC is:

2.1.2.1. The coordinating authority to integrate, implement, and evaluate force development initiatives, requirements, resources, strategies, operations, and tactics, with special attention to velocity and quality in delivery and agility in adaptation, as well as the planning, programming, budgeting, and execution of same.

2.1.2.2. The coordinating authority to integrate military pre-commissioning standards and training between the United States Air Force Academy, USAF Reserve Officer Training Corps, Officer Training School, and Warrant Officer Training School.

2.1.2.3. The coordinating authority to integrate professional military education standards with USSF.

2.1.2.4. The direct liaison authority (DIRLAUTH) with the individuals, offices, and/or governance structures within United States federal, state, and local government agencies and organizations, international partners or allies, civilian educational organizations, and commercial industries, as required to execute and optimize the AETC mission. Note: In accordance with Title 10 United States Code (USC) Section 10501, the National Guard Bureau is the channel of communications between the DAF and the states on all matters pertaining to the Air National Guard of the United States.

2.2. The COMAETC commands and controls the following primary subordinate units, whose primary missions are executing the identified portions of the command's mission.

2.2.1. Second Air Force. Executes the technical training and education portions of the AETC mission.

2.2.2. Nineteenth Air Force. Executes the aviation training and education portions of the AETC mission.

2.2.3. Air University. Executes the professional military education, warfighter education, and leadership development portions of the AETC mission. Through the LeMay Center, serves as the CSAF's center for doctrine development and lessons learned.

2.2.4. Air Force Accessions Center. Executes the recruiting, accessions, and citizen development portion of the AETC mission.

2.2.5. The 502nd Air Base Wing. Provides base operations and support functions for Joint Base San Antonio.

2.3. AETC Supporting Relationships.

2.3.1. AETC is the supported command for force development per **paragraph 2.1.1.1**. As such, other personnel or units may be required or requested by an appropriate authority or agreement to execute or support a specified portion of an AETC mission.

2.3.2. When personnel or units are executing or supporting a specified portion of an AETC mission, those individuals or units are subject to the authorities and directive issuances required to execute or support those specific missions.

3. Responsibilities. COMAETC is responsible for:

3.1. Provide force development, institutional training, and leader development activities, opportunities, and services based on the competencies that introduce, enhance, or expand uniformed Airman capabilities.

3.2. Provide force development, institutional training, and leader development activities, opportunities, and services to USAF civilians and non-USAF personnel in support of United States government contracts, treaties, and other such binding agreements or as directed by Headquarters Air Force.

3.3. Establish and implement comprehensive, integrated marketing and strategic communication strategies to advance recruiting activities for the Regular Air Force, Space Force, and Air Force Reserve.

3.4. Establish and publish guidance and standards to execute and evaluate the force development mission.

3.5. Develop and chair governance structures below the management headquarters level that determine enterprise-wide integration, strategic alignment, and requirement prioritization within the AETC mission areas with advice from functional authorities, representatives, and subject matter experts.

3.6. Guide all competency-based career field education and training plans and other equivalent authoritative documents and support Career Field Managers in developing and assessing career field development requirements that meet USAF mission needs.

3.7. Provide a universally accessible learning record that documents education, training, and experience to provide commanders insight into the health and strength of the force.

3.8. Identify, catalog, and evaluate external education, training, and development opportunities and products used to expand current capability.

3.9. Establish development pathways for critical technical areas to leverage, vector, and incentivize people to serve in highly perishable and rapidly evolving skill sets.

3.10. Link force development, institutional training, and leader development outcomes with operational training and mission requirements.

3.11. Align force development capabilities with future Force Design, operational concepts, and modernization plans.

3.12. Develop and implement data standards and governance structures for learning management and student information systems, consistent with DAF policy, to enable Department-wide insights into the competencies and capabilities of the force that in turn support Force Design and other strategic and operational decision making.

3.13. Develop planning and analysis tools which guide and inform force development, institutional training, and leader development priorities, planning, programming, budgeting, and execution decisions and processes.

3.14. Identify, evaluate, validate, and prioritize force development resource requirements (e.g., manpower, equipment, learning technology, facilities, funding, etc.) across the USAF.

3.15. Secure funding, manpower, and technological resources (e.g., data analytics, virtual and augmented realities, artificial intelligence, emerging technologies, etc.) required to enable, enhance, integrate, and support force development, institutional training, and leadership development activities, opportunities, and services.

3.16. Support the Air Force Forces Generation (AFFORGEN) deployment model, or current force presentation model, by providing mission ready Airmen and/or equipment for contingency taskings.

JOHN D. LAMONTAGNE, General, USAF
Vice Chief of Staff of the United States Air Force

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

10 USC 10501, National Guard Bureau

DAFPD 38-1, Manpower and Organization, 20 February 2024

DAFI 38-107, Air Force Mission Directives, 16 September 2025

DAFI 90-160, Publications and Forms Management, 13 April 2022

DAFMAN 90-161, Publishing Processes and Procedures, 17 October 2023

AFI 33-322, Records Management and Information Governance Program, 23 March 2020

Adopted Forms

AF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AETC—Air Education and Training Command

AFI—Air Force Instruction

AFMD—Air Force Mission Directive

COMAETC—Commander, AETC

CSAF—Chief of Staff of the Air Force

Terms

Accessions—A process for ensuring new personnel possess the capabilities, potential, and suitability for service. Prepares individuals for entry into military work environments by providing learning activities that introduce the organization's culture, foundational competencies, history, mission, structures, and values.

Citizen Development—Junior Reserve Officers' Training Corps (JROTC) is a congressionally mandated program designed to instill in students within secondary educational schools the value of citizenship, service to the United States, personal responsibility, and a sense of accomplishment.

Competencies—A combination of knowledge, skills, abilities, and other characteristics manifesting in observable and measurable pattern of behaviors required for mission success.

Development Pathway—A comprehensive framework encompassing training, education, and experiential learning activities and opportunities designed to enhance human capabilities and competencies. It spans the entire lifecycle of an individual's service, beginning from the commitment to enter a particular field, such as the Air Force, and continuing throughout one's career until separation or retirement.

Direct Liaison Authority—An authority granted by a commander (any level) to a subordinate to directly consult or coordinate an action with a command or agency within or outside of the granting command. This authority carries with it the requirement of keeping the commander granting the

authority informed. Note: This authority is not an authority through which command may be exercised.

Education—Academic and experiential learning focused on general bodies of knowledge, principles within a given discipline, and habits of the mind. This type of learning is applicable to a broad spectrum of foundational and/or occupational competencies.

Experiential Learning—Formal and informal experiences (e.g., field exercises, internships, or simulations), which enhance and expand an individual's competencies. This type of learning activity provides immersive and challenging environments, broadens perspectives, encourages reflective thinking, introduces new or enhances existing competencies, and allows for the observation of a learner's real-time actions.

Force Design—Envisioned capabilities, organizational structure, operating concepts, and policies that inform future investments; what the Air Force should look like and missions it should be able to accomplish to meet the National Security Strategy

Force Development—The deliberate effort to maximize force readiness through a variety of recruiting, educational, training, and experiential learning activities, opportunities, and services ensuring all Airmen and Guardians possess the competencies they need to meet DAF mission requirements.

Foundational Competencies—A set of accepted, transferrable, and valued competencies, which enable success across a wide-array of DAF missions, roles, functions, and duties.

Functional Authority—Authority residing with designated General Officers or members of the Senior Executive Service serving as Deputy Chiefs of Staff or Assistant Secretaries appointed by the Secretary of the Air Force to provide oversight and functional advisory services related to functional communities.

Institutional Training—A spectrum of training activities that develops a uniformed Airman's foundational and occupational competencies throughout their career, to include learning the use of equipment or development of occupationally-centric skills to prepare the warfighter for success in future operational training. Training enables execution of a career field- unique function at an individual competency level and, over time, a graduated scale of mastery. By its nature, Institutional Training is cross-cutting in that it develops Airmen regardless of specialty or develops occupational competencies consistent across multiple environments or organizations.

Leader Development—Harnesses both professional military education and degree-granting education, as well as unique experiences, both operational and leader-focused, that expand and reinforce the capability of Airmen.

Occupational Competencies—A set of competencies required of all Airmen within a specific workforce category. They describe functional behaviors correlated with performance on the job, which leads to mission success.

Operational Training—Training that develops foundational and occupational competencies oriented to warfighting readiness by integrating functional experts in cohesive teams, focused on mission outcomes, e.g., the application of airpower and/or other operations to generate effects in a specific operating environment. Operational training differs from institutional training in its focus on employment of a weapon system in an operational setting, or as part of a Joint or mission team, as opposed to learning the use of equipment or development of occupationally centric skills.

Recruiting—The overall process of attracting, selecting, classifying, and enrolling qualified individuals for entry into military service.

Training—Formal and informal learning focused on proficiency development, which is the attainment and retention of skills, knowledge, and attitudes required to meet a specific function or job performance.

Transactional Functions—Transactional operations currently done by AFPC, HAF/SAF policy responsibilities (e.g., force management), casualty/mortuary operations, over-arching human resources and information technology systems, civilian force development, and senior leader (SES/0-6/E-9 and above) development.